

Summary of Voodoo Hackathon Guidelines and Expectations

The Voodoo Hackathon welcomes exceptionally talented developers to engage in a thoughtfully designed challenge focused on problem-solving rather than speed. The event emphasizes **scalable, well-structured, and clear coding practices** over rapid development, encouraging participants to showcase their technical and logical skills through real-world project development.

Key Focus Areas

- **Technical Skills and Logical Thinking:**

Developers must demonstrate solid technical proficiency and logical problem-solving ability, especially in handling dynamic, real-world projects.

- **Database Design and Backend Development:**

- Strong preference for projects that involve **database modeling and backend API design**.
- Use of local databases such as **MySQL** and **PostgreSQL** is encouraged.
- Avoid reliance on Backend-as-a-Service (BaaS) platforms like Firebase, Supabase, or MongoDB Atlas to minimize **dependency risks** caused by third-party bugs or outages.
- Building projects largely from scratch with minimal third-party API usage is preferred.

- **Data Handling and Validation:**

- Use of **real-time and dynamic data** is expected for final solutions; static JSON is acceptable only for prototyping.
- Implement **robust input validation** to handle user errors gracefully (e.g., invalid email inputs must trigger user feedback).

- **Version Control and Collaboration:**

- Proper use of **Git and GitHub** is critical, stressing that version control is a **team effort** rather than managed by a single individual.

- **User Interface and User Experience:**

- The UI should be **clean, interactive, and visually consistent** with coherent color schemes and layout.
- Navigation must be **intuitive**, with well-organized menus, proper spacing, and logical flow.

- **Teamwork and Presentation:**

- All team members should participate in project presentations to demonstrate **shared ownership** and collaboration.
- Emphasis is not on individual speaking skills but on **teamwork and collective responsibility**.

- **Use of Modern Technologies:**

- Incorporation of trendy technologies such as **AI, blockchain, or chatbots** is encouraged only if they **add genuine value** to the project.
- Understanding the tools is crucial; developers must comprehend the purpose and function of any code or technology they employ rather than copying it blindly.

Evaluation Criteria

The judging panel will assess submissions based on the following:

Criterion	Description
Coding Standards	Code quality, style, and adherence to best practices
Logic	Problem-solving approach and algorithmic soundness
Modularity	Use of modular architecture and reusable components
Front-End Design	UI/UX quality including visual appeal and interactivity
Performance	Responsiveness and efficiency in execution
Scalability	Ability to handle growth and increased load
Security	Protection against vulnerabilities and secure coding practices
Usability	Ease of use and user experience
Debugging Skills	Ability to identify and fix bugs effectively
Database Design	Quality and robustness of database modeling and interaction
Approach to Problem	Thoughtfulness and innovation in addressing the problem statement
Attention to Detail	Careful implementation and thoroughness

Additional Guidelines and Encouragement

- The hackathon encourages participants to **choose problem statements that inspire them** and to bring their ideas to life through **collaboration and innovation**.
- The overall experience should be **enjoyable and educational**, with the goal of not only creating impressive projects but also identifying potential talent for future team recruitment.

****In summary, the Voodoo Hackathon prioritizes thoughtful design, solid technical foundations, teamwork, and real-world applicability, aiming to discover developers capable of building scalable, secure, and user-friendly solutions with strong backend and database expertise.****